

FIEOCHAON RPG



ROLE PLAYING GAME

The Field of Chaos game is a narrative driven role playing game. There are two primary roles in the game. The role of the Controller who directs the game with narration and adjudication and the role of the Player who acts out a Character in the game. There can be only one Controller in a game. There can be any number of Players from one to potentially as many as ten. The distinction between a Player and a Character is that the Player plays the Character in the game. When a Character is described in this writing it refers to the in-game entity. When a Player is described it represents the person playing the game.

In addition to this document, you will need at least five six-sided dice. The six sided dice is the regular dice you would find in a variety of board games and it should be easy purchased or found through other games that use dice.

You will also need paper and pencils or pens. It is important to keep a written record of various parts of the game. If you are a Player, you will need to keep a record of your Character. Similarly, if you are the Controller, you will keep records on Characters as well but also notes on the game and potentially additional Characters that aren't played by Players but are played by the Controller.

HOUSE RULES

The rules provided here are designed to give a guide to play. It must be acknowledged here explicitly that these may not be the only rules that are needed for the game or a Controller or Players may want to play a game. House rules (that is rules created separate from the rules presented here) are not only permitted by this game, they are actively encouraged.

If a Controller or potentially even Players find particular rules are not working for them in their frequent play of this game, please add or changes the rules accordingly. The only formal requirement for house rules is that they are written down in some form (either paper or electronic) and that all participants in the game agree to the house rules prior to the game beginning.

NARRATIVE

Consider the purpose of the experience of playing Field of Chaos to explore a rich universe and develop your character (or your players) through this experience. Rather than creating life and death circumstances at every turn of the game, consider the development of scenarios in the game as being a means of choosing distinct character paths and also exploring the particularly twisted and complex universe.

There are, however, a wide variety of conditions other than death that can end the game. The loss of a character's physical and/or mental mobility may cause the game to end. Capture and/or imprisonment may leave the

character in an immobile state. Although either case could also be used as the starting point of another scenario.

Consider the narrative flow the most important element of the game. At the time of writing there is only one work available to review the style of narrative used in Field of Chaos however this rule book will also provide a number of techniques and background examples to assist with creating a detailed narrative both as a Player and a Controller.

DISPUTES

Through the course of a game, as there are many points of tension that could result in disputes between Players or disputes between Players and the Controller. All disputes must be resolved with a dice role. In the case where a particular rule is in question, if the rule can not be found within about two minutes, this dispute must be resolved with a dice role. The purpose of the game is to have fun and explore an alternative world. Hostility generated through disputes spoils the game for all concerned.



In the case of a dispute between two participants, one participant picks odd, the other picks even. A dice is rolled and based on whether the roll odd or even the participant who nominated the outcome rule has their decision met.

In the case of a dispute with three participants, each participant nominates a number 1, 2 or 3. The dice is rolled and in the case of a 1 or a 4, the participant who picked 1 has their decision met. In the case of a 2 or a 5, the participant who picked 2 has their decision met. In the remaining outcomes, the participant who picked 3 has their decision met.

If there are more than three participants in dispute, some of the participants need to come to agreement resolving down to two or three groups so the dice can be rolled. An alternative solution, has the participants taking a vote to see which two or three possibilities are the most reasonable to roll on.

STATISTICS

There are five numerical statistics in the game. These are:

- Regular Knowledge (RE)
- Irregular Knowledge (IR)
- Appearance (AP)
- Physical Health (PH)
- Mental Health (ME)

Each of these skills have the value between 0 and 10 with the total of all five numerical skills not exceeding 30 initially. It should be possible to extend the character though detailed and focused play to move the maximum limit of these five values combined to 40. This is the maximum possible for any character in the game. In general, a controller may want to cap the total to something between 30 and 40 to avoid overly powerful characters.

All other skills including weapons operation and any skills that will effect combat are awarded through skill paths. The concept of skill paths indicate that all skills will either be entry level skills or have prerequisite requirements. These skills are built up over time and through specific actions. All skills have to be learned in some way. The skills offered in this book are only a small part of the total skills available through the game. Through house

rules and future book updates numerous other skills can be offered. For this reason the weighting on statistics linkings to skill are based on the skills available here.

Regular Intelligence (RE) describes broadly the kind of intelligence that is academically represented. It is a statistic that lends itself to a wide variety of skills too. For this reason, a player may consider Regular Intelligence to be the most important statistic. This should be counteracted with the practical use of the skills gained through Regular Intelligence when compared to Physical Health or Mental Health.

Irregular Intelligence (IR) is slightly more idiomatic than Regular Intelligence. It would be too easy to define it as everything relating to intelligence and knowledge not covered by Regular Intelligence however broadly this is what Irregular Intelligence describes. It may be easier to summarize that while Regular Intelligence is the ability to learn and use knowledge, Irregular Intelligence is the ability to understand things with limited experience and in a variety of different fields that would not normally be covered by Regular Intelligence.

Appearance (AP) describes not only how a Character appears relative to a cross section of society, it also denotes a subtle class classification. Appearance governs not only the general upkeep of the Character but also the kind of clothing and physical attitude of the Character. It should be assumed that Appearance also has some age bias built into it. Generally a younger Character would have a lower Appearance as they are more heavily governed by their peer group and their own access to money and other direct indications of status. It is perfectly possible for adults to have low Appearance too. In some circumstances of relative wealth, young people may also have a higher Appearance than their peers. This is statistically unlikely but through the freedom of statistics a Player may wish to create a character like this.

Physical Health (PH), as the name suggests, describes the general health of the Character. The higher the Physical Health, generally the better the Character can do strenuous activity. The lower the Physical Health, the less likely a Character is to do vast amounts of physical activity without a suitable penalty associated with rest or general inability to continue.

Mental Health (ME) represents the character's mental state including conditions of fatigue. A low Mental Health does not characterize mental illness although a low Mental Health can make a Character more susceptible to mental illness.

In this book, by far the majority of skills offered come through Regular Intelligence (RE). For this reason if Players want to take advantage just of skill maximization, they should maximize their RE. There are roughly equal numbers of skills for Irregular Intelligence (IR), Physical Health (PH) and Mental Health (ME). There are only a small number of skills for Appearance (AP) however appearance plays an important role in the game quite distinct from the other statistics. A Character's ability to move through an environment without attracting attention is based on their Appearance (AP) relative to the environment around them. This can be masked somewhat by skills like Disguise and Evade however fundamentally if a Character does not have a reasonable Appearance, they will have problems moving through areas that require a high Appearance to fit in. Similarly if they maintain a high Appearance, the Character may have problems moving through an environment that has a low Appearance norm. This will be described in greater detail through the introductory scenarios offered in this book.

GAME DYNAMICS

The game only requires three six sided dice (also known as d6) to play. In addition to the lack of dice, there are only two dice rolling methods used in the game.

There are five Character statistics. Through the course of many games these statistics could move through the range from 0 to 10 however initially these values will be through the range 2 to 8. It is important to note that in some situations for some characters it is better to have lower values for these statistics than higher values. A player coming to a character may want them to fit in to particular circumstances, blend in to similar circumstances and stand out in other circumstances. The statistic Appearance (AP) is a good example of this. If a player expects they will be part of a downbeat community that wears soiled clothes and general does not provide the same level of grooming that a corporate environment would demand, the player would select a low appearance for a particular character. Similarly if a player suspects a low level of Regular Knowledge would be beneficial so a character does not stand out in a particular group, then this may also be a statistic the player opts to downgrade.

In addition to the Statistics used for each Character, a number of elements in the game are described by Skills too. Skills are named formally in any Field of Chaos rule book or can also be named through house rules. These Skills are given percentage values (that is values from 0 to 100).



STATISTICS GENERATION

The mechanic for finding a Character's statistic is as follows:

- i* The Player rolls three dice. These three numbers are recorded.
- ii* The Player then can select any two of these dice for the results on the dice face. The dice can be turned to the face surface and these two numbers are recorded.¹
- iii* The Player has five numbers written down. (x, y, z, 7-x, 7-y)
- iv* The Player then selects one of these five numbers and adds two to that number. The four remaining numbers have one added per number. Again this is the Player's choice which number has two added to it.
- v* The Player can then pick which of these five values connect with the five statistics for their Character.

Three Examples of Statistics Generation

- i* The player rolls three dice. These numbers are 3, 6 and 1.
- ii* The player choses to turn the dice with 1 and the dice with 3 onto the facing side.
- iii* This gives the results 6 and 4. The player now has five numbers 3, 6, 1, 4 and 6.
- iv* The player nominates the 1 to have the plus 2 and the remaining rolls have plus 1, taking the five numbers:

$$3 + 1 = 4$$

$$6 + 1 = 7$$

$$1 + 2 = 3$$

$$4 + 1 = 5$$

$$6 + 1 = 7$$

- v* The player wants a character who is street smart, and book smart with lower physical health and roughly average mental health. Thus the statistics are chosen as:

RE	IR	AP	PH	ME
7	7	3	4	5

¹ If you are good with mathematics, simply take seven and subtract the number on top for both dice individually as this produces the same result as rotating the two dice from their faces.

- i* Another player rolls three dice. These values are 2, 4 and 3.
- ii* The player elects to turn the 2 and 3 dice to their opposite faces.
- iii* This gives 5 and 4. This gives the player initially the numbers 2, 4, 3, 5 and 4.
- iv* The player elects to put the plus two value on the 5 with the remaining values receiving the plus one.

$$2 + 1 = 3$$

$$4 + 1 = 5$$

$$3 + 1 = 4$$

$$5 + 2 = 7$$

$$4 + 1 = 5$$

- v* The player wants to create a character with strong physical health and a reasonable appearance the remaining statistics are unimportant to the player.

RE	IR	AP	PH	ME
4	3	5	7	5

- i* Another player rolls the three dice. These result in values 2, 6 and 5.
- ii* The player opts to turn the 2 and 5 dice to their face values, 5 and 2 respectively.
- iii* This gives five number 2, 6, 5, 5 and 2.
- iv* The player opts to add the two to one of the 2 rolls giving:

$$2 + 2 = 4$$

$$6 + 1 = 7$$

$$5 + 1 = 6$$

$$5 + 1 = 6$$

$$2 + 1 = 3$$

- v* The player doesn't have many options as this has produced an even weighted set of numbers. As the player does not know how the game will develop they allocate the statistics as follows:

RE	IR	AP	PH	ME
6	3	6	7	4

This is a relatively average character with the ability to strengthen and weaken some of these values through a number of games.

The rules associated with increasing and decreasing these values will be discussed in the Controller section of this book.

Mathematically astute players will note a total statistics value range from 21 to 26 which is slightly under the average being at 25 and indicates a preference for lower results initially. This in part is true however the way the play themselves selects which two of the three dice are negated by the two dice totaling 7 spread, means this number is closer to the 25 average total. Also the player's statistics should initially be lower to allow for the additional increases needed through the game and the accessibility of Anti-System groups to young players. This will be expanded further in the setting component adjacent to the basic rules.

SKILLS

A player is allowed once skill per statistic point in each area. Prerequisites are noted and have to be covered this skill accounting too.

Regular Intelligence

Anti-Viral Software (requires Computer Programming)

Artificial Intelligence (requires Computer Programming)

Biology, Basic

Botany (requires Basic Biology and Horticulture)

Cartography (requires Basic Geography and Visual Art)

Chemistry, Basic

Chemistry, Advanced (requires Basic Chemistry)

Chemistry, Pharmaceutical (requires Advanced Chemistry and Basic Biology)

Computer Operation

Computer Programming (requires Computer Operation)

Computer Repair

Cryptography (requires Advanced Mathematics)

Electronics, Basic

Electronics Repair (requires Basic Electronics)

Electronics Operation (requires Basic Electronics)

First Aid

Geography, Basic

History, Basic

Horticulture

Language Written, Primary (requires Primary Language Spoken)

Language Written, Secondary (requires Secondary Language Spoken)

Mathematics, Basic

Mathematics, Advanced (requires Basic Mathematics)

Musical Performance

Paramedic (requires First Aid)

Psychology, Basic

Zoology (requires Basic Biology)

Irregular Intelligence

Computer Virus Creation (requires Computer Programming)

Explosive Engineering (requires Basic Chemistry)

Forgery (requires Visual Art)

Lock-picking

Hacking (requires Computer Operation)

Hunting

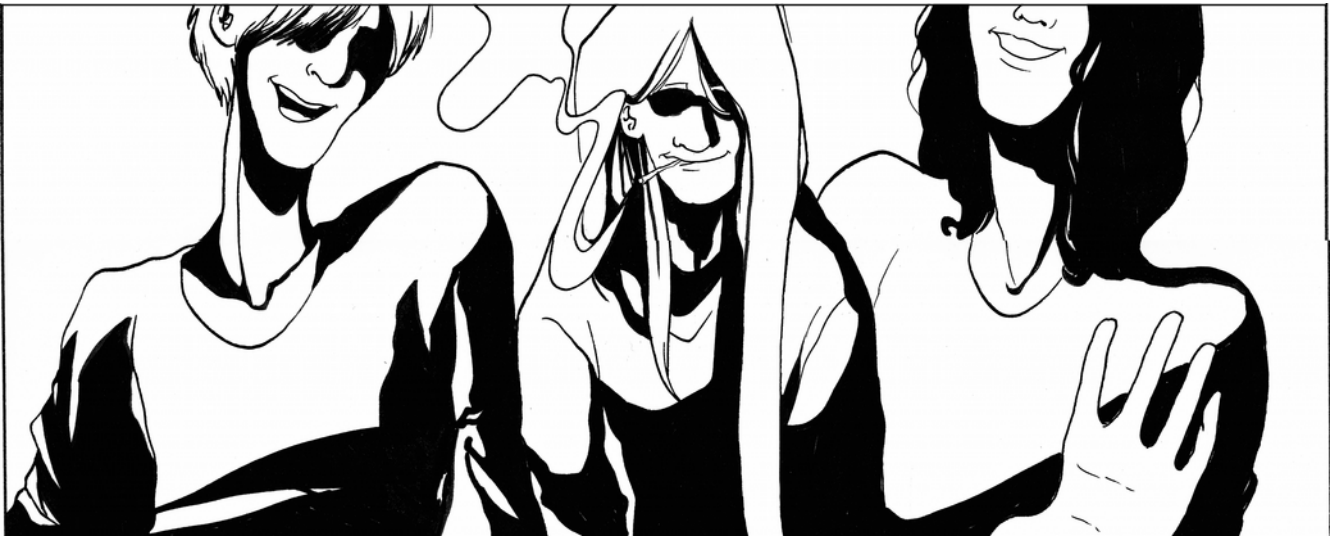
Manufacture Clandestine Weapon (requires Carpentry)

Track (requires Disguise)

Improvised Weapon Use, Basic

Clandestine Weapon Use, Basic

Wilderness Survival, Advanced (requires Basic Wilderness Survival)



Appearance

Disguise

Evade

Etiquette (requires Basic Manners)

Orate (requires Primary Spoken Language)

Physical Health

Canoeing

Carpentry

Close Combat

Cycling

Marching

Running

Sailboating

Swimming

Firearm Use, Basic

Wilderness Survival, Basic



Mental Health

Drive Car

Drive Motorcycle

Firearm Use, Advanced (requires Basic Firearm Use)

Interrogation (requires Basic Psychology)

Impersonate (requires Disguise)

Language Spoken, Primary

Language Spoken, Secondary (requires Primary Language Spoken)

Manners, Basic

Pilot Plane

Visual Art

For example:

RE	IR	AP	PH	ME
6	3	6	7	4

RE Skills

Computer Operation → Computer Programming → Artificial Intelligence

First Aid

Electronics, Basic → Electronics Repair

IR Skills

Computer Virus Creation

Hunting

Hacking

AP Skills

Disguise

Evade

Orate

PH Skills

Firearm Use, Basic

Swimming

Wilderness Survival, Basic

Marching

Close Combat

Carpentry

Cycling

ME Skills

Firearm Use, Advanced

Manners, Basic

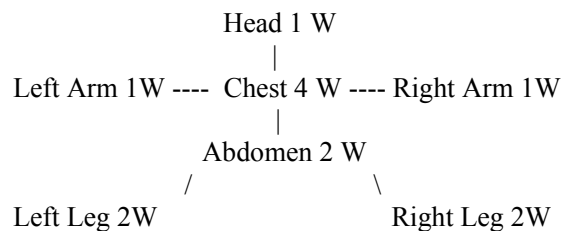
Language Spoken, Primary

Drive Car



WOUNDS

Health is attributed to sections of the body. In general a player will start with the following amount of potential wounds:



A leg with 0 wounds remaining halves movement. If both legs have 0 wounds remaining, the Character can't move. A Character with 0 wounds remaining in one arm can not fire a firearm. A Character with 0 wounds remaining either the head, chest or abdomen are unconscious. A Character with less than 6 wounds remaining is in grave condition. Once a character drops to no wounds remaining they are considered dead.

BULLET HITS

To hit from bullet:

Leg	3-8
Chest	9-13
Abdomen	14-15
Arm	16-17
Head	18

Arms and Legs

Left	Odd
Right	Even

MELEE HITS

x d6	1 / + 1* / + 2**
To hit from blow	3-6
To hit from weapon	4-6

TO HEAL

Without any medical skills, roll 1 dice per turn. On a 6, one wound is recovered. If a bandage or other medical equipment is used, on a 5-6, one wound is recovered. With first aid skills, two dice can be rolled and the top value is picked. With paramedic skills, three dice are rolled and the top dice is picked.

HISTORY

Early 1990s – A small armed insurrection occurs. In the process of squashing the insurrection a substantial number of civilians are killed. This ferments a revolutionary spirit in a majority of the population. This divides the population based on social classes with the wealthy and the quisling middle-class forming their own communities.

Late 1990s – In cracking down on the majority, walled and militarized settlements are created in existing cities. These environments are specially policed and controlled. Economic wealth flows to those elite areas while the majority of the population are forced into high-rise apartment towers.

1999 – Led by a small group of youthful leaders, the majority population attempt a revolution against the ruling elite. This includes the use of dirty bomb technology and ultimately leaves a majority of the environment in ruin following excessive bombing of the majority population.

2003 – Following a brief lull in the fighting and an observed truce, the ruling elite attempts a mass extermination program forcing the majority population into labor camps leaving the created cities virtually deserted. Armed insurrection follows.

Mid-2000s – The fighting continues. For the majority, all economic resources dry up. The majority are left to fend for themselves through the huge crumbling cities that are left. Some try creating agricultural communes as a means of growing food however these fail and mass starvation further reduces the majority population.

2012 – A truce is declared as a means of further concentrating the majority and eradicating them. Small groups of the majority continue to hide in the ruined cities and form roving revolutionary gangs dressed in the clothes of their parents' last factory jobs.

Mid-2010s – Increasingly cultist, the ruling class begins a series of experiments to try to create a sub-human species including attempts at resurrection and various other strange experiments.

General Notes

Technology has been stifled through years of war. The internet does not exist however a cultist mythology around modem connected networks (known as the Wazarin) forms the basis for any electronic communication. History prior to the 1990s is conveyed through mythology.

The history outlined above is a limited overview designed to give a player a basic understanding of what their Character knows.

HOUSE RULES FOR FIEOCHAON RPG

	Close Range	Standard Range	Long Range
Sniper Rifle	24"	36"	48"
Rifle	18"	27"	36"
Carbine	12"	18"	24"
Automatic	8"	12"	16"
SubMG	6"	9"	12"
x d6	1 / + 1* / + 2**	2 / + 1* / + 2**	3 / + 1* / + 2**
Required to hit	4-6	10-12	16-18
Head Shot	6	12	18

	Light	Heavy
Cover Modifier	-1	-2

	Standard	Fast
Movement Modifier	-1	-2

	Target Has Evade
Skill Modifiers	-1

Examples

A player with advanced firearms training and rifle fires at a stationary target in light cover 20" away. Standard range 2 dice, plus 2 dice (advanced), minus 1 dice (light cover) means a roll of three dice picking top two dice with 10-12 to hit.

A player with no firearms training and a sniper rifle fires at a target 35" away running (Fast Movement). Long range 3 dice minus 2 dice (fast movement) means 1 dice – no chance of hitting (getting 16-18 on 2 dice).

A player with firearms training and a SubMG fire at a target 10" away in light cover. Long range 3 dice plus 1 dice (training) minus 1 dice (light cover) means a roll of three dice with a chance of hitting on 16-18.

	Shots per turn	Movement Rule	Special rules
Sniper Rifle	1	Very slow	Can't fire under 12" or VS Rifle
Rifle	1 or 2**	Slow	
Carbine	1 or 2**	Standard	
Automatic	2	Standard	Jam 1 on 2d6 + No HS
SubMG	3	Fast	Jam 1 on 1d6 + No HS

A standard clip has 10 rounds. It takes a turn to change a clip.

Head Shots

- Called two moves prior.
- Miss two moves then fires.
- Missed head shots miss altogether.

Movement

Very Slow	2" / + 1* (* Has Evade Skill)
Slow	3" / + 1* (* Has Marching Skill)
Standard	5" / + 1* (* Has Marching Skill)
Fast	8" / +2* (* Has Running Skill)

There are two languages available – Majority and Elite.

FOES

Animal

Head shot releases Psychnosis Gas (only achieves head shot on 5-6 on d6).

Gas Attack – Psychnosis Gas (Double rolls required / half move).

Gas cloud covers d6 + 6" radius and reduces 2" per turn moving in 2" direction d6.

+1 dice for all attacks.

Hunter

+ 1 movement.

Soldiers

Every shot wound has an armor save (5-6 on d6), including headshots.